PATTERN PRODIGY

Pacing guide · 7 class periods

PACING

Teacher

7 class periods, as on my project menu. The “My plan” column is my day-by-day pacing guide as I wrote it; the other columns show what to put on the screen and in students’ hands.

CLASS	MY PLAN	TEACHER MOVES	DECK	STUDENT PAGES
CLASS 1	**Class 1:** Introduction to Step Sequencer and Pattern Regions. Guided exploration.	Slides 1–7: hook, what the project is, the steps, five words, steps 1 and 2. Hand out the project sheet and the Pattern grids. Guide the class through a first drum pattern; no audio is included.	Slides 1–7	p. 13, p. 17, p. 18, p. 19, p. 21
CLASS 2	**Class 2:** Build drum/percussion patterns. Begin adding melodic layers.	Slides 8–10: reading a pattern grid, not only drums, step 3. Demo a melodic pattern early (my first struggle). Check each student has a drum groove.	Slides 8–10	p. 14
CLASS 3	**Classes 3–5:** Working days — explore automation, probability, variation.	Slides 11–13: four ways to evolve, step 4 and the worked example on paper. Hand out the Arrangement plan. Then work time.	Slides 11–13	p. 15
CLASS 4		Slides 14–15: probability is your friend, and mix and refine. Hand out the Listen-back sheet. Then work time.	Slides 14–15	p. 16
CLASS 5		Full working day: automate, vary, arrange. Ask each student to loop one bar and say which step they would change next.	No new slides	—
CLASS 6	**Class 6:** Final mix, bounce. Prepare presentations.	Slides 16–18: bounce, what to turn in, the rubric. Students post their three Padlet questions.	Slides 16–18	p. 20, p. 22
CLASS 7	**Class 7:** Presentations with Padlet Q&A peer feedback.	Slides 19–20: presentation day and the close. Every student presents and answers 2 of each classmate’s questions. Reflection (page 23) follows the presentations.	Slides 19–20	p. 22, p. 23

THE ONE THING TO SHOW ON CLASS 1

Put a hi-hat on a grid and give a step a 50% chance (my third struggle). Loop it for a few bars so the class hears it change. Do the same on a bass row so it is not only for drums.

CLASSES 3–5

Working days; Class 5 has no new slide. Circulate with one question: which feature changed the sound you just heard?

PREVIEW

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PATTERN PRODIGY

Worked example · an invented groove

EXAMPLE

Teacher

An **invented piece, "Night Shift", described on paper**: no audio is included. Students' projects will differ. 20 bars at 96 BPM, four sections, five layers, five Step Sequencer features (page 1 of 2).

1 · A WEAK PLAN

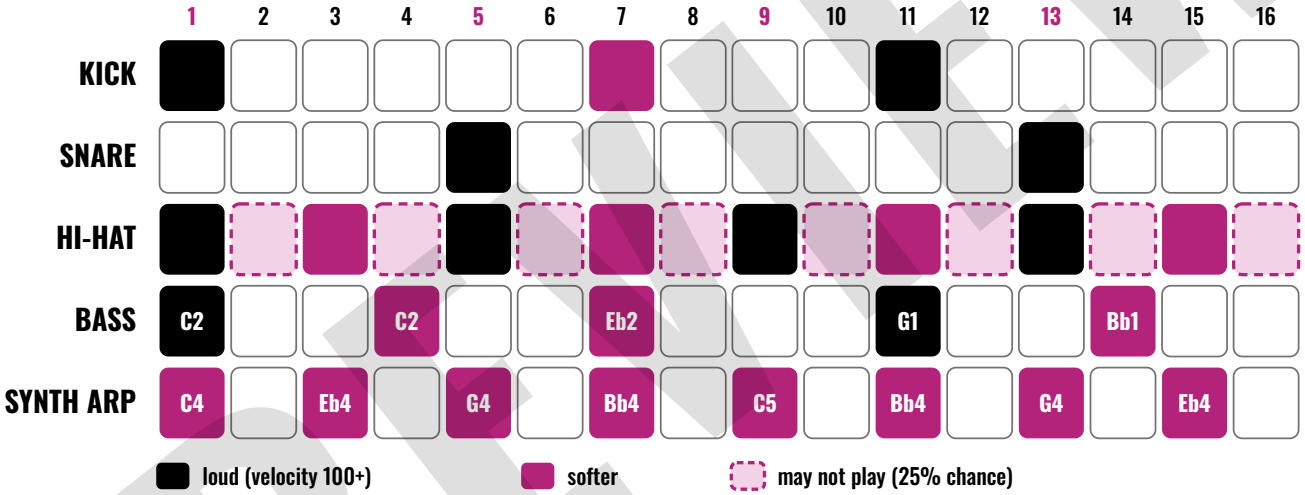
I will make a beat with drums and a bass.

It names no features and nothing says what will change.

2 · A CLEAR PLAN

I am making "Night Shift", a 50-second groove at 96 BPM. It opens with kick and snare, and the hi-hat row is unmuted at bar 3. A bass pattern arrives at bar 5 and a synth arp at bar 9. I will use five Step Sequencer features: probability on the hat's even steps, velocity accents, a cutoff on every step of the arp, mute and unmute, and an alternate drum pattern for the Build. Four automation lanes keep it moving, and in the last four bars it thins out.

3 · ONE BAR OF THE GROOVE: 16 STEPS ·



The bass plays C, Eb, G and Bb (C minor 7) on steps 1, 4, 7, 11 and 14, and the synth arp climbs C, Eb, G, Bb, C and comes back down on the odd steps. Every pitch is a chord tone, so the layers agree. Hat velocity: 100 on steps 1, 5, 9, 13 and 70 on the other odd steps; the even steps are ghosts at 25% probability.

4 · THE FIVE FEATURES IT USES ·

Probability	the hi-hat's even steps play 25% of the time; raised by hand to 60% in the Build
Velocity	hat accents on steps 1, 5, 9 and 13 (100) over softer ones (70); kick and snare at about 90 to 110
Step automation	the synth arp's filter cutoff has its own value on every step, rising from 15 to 97
Mute / unmute	the hat row is unmuted at bar 3; the snare row is muted at bar 19
Pattern alternate	a second drum pattern, B, plays in bars 13–16 and then the first returns

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PATTERN PRODIGY

Project sheet · requirements and steps

STUDENT

Name _____ Date _____

REQUIREMENTS ·

- ☐ Length: 30–60 seconds
- ☐ Use at least 3 different Step Sequencer features
- ☐ Include at least one drum kit, one bass or synth, and one additional element
- ☐ Demonstrate balance, clarity, and creative use of space in your mix

STEPS / PROCESS ·

1. **Explore** — Open the Step Sequencer and experiment with basic drum patterns (Pattern grids: page 13)
2. **Build rhythms** — Create your core drum and percussion patterns
3. **Add melodic layers** — Program bass and synth patterns that complement your groove
4. **Automate and vary** — Use probability, velocity, and automation to make patterns evolve (Feature tracker: page 14)
5. **Mix and refine** — Apply EQ, panning, and plug-ins. Arrange into a cohesive piece. (Arrangement plan: page 15; Listen-back sheet: page 16)
6. **Finalize** — Bounce your track and prepare your presentation
7. **Present & Get Feedback** — Create your own Padlet post with 3 questions you want classmates to answer about your project. Present to the class. During classmates' presentations, answer at least 2 of their 3 questions on their Padlet post.

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PATTERN PRODIGY

Rubric

RUBRIC

/ 25

Name _____ Date _____

GRADING RUBRIC /25

Pattern Prodigy | Structured Project

Each category is scored 1–5. Your final grade is the average of your self-score and your teacher's score.

Category	1	2	3	4	5
CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	Minimal creative effort; relies on defaults or clichés	Some creative ideas but largely predictable	Shows originality; experiments with sound or style	Highly creative; unique approach with clear artistic intent	Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	Limited understanding of Logic Pro tools	Basic tool use with frequent errors	Competent workflow; uses tools correctly	Advanced use of Logic features and shortcuts	Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	Disorganized; no clear form or direction	Some structure present but underdeveloped	Clear, cohesive form with logical sections	Engaging structure with dynamic progression	Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc
SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY	Poor sound choices; unbalanced or muddy mix	Some variety but inconsistent levels and EQ	Good sound selection; mostly balanced mix	Strong sound palette; clean, well-balanced mix	Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	Missing or incomplete; no reflection	Minimal documentation with little insight	Satisfactory; provides basic detail and reflection	Well-documented; clear and thoughtful reflection	Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery

Student Score: _____ / 25	Teacher Score: _____ / 25
Final Grade = Average of Student + Teacher = _____ / 25	

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